

August 2026

Dear Sandra,

I've worked in Lafayette long enough to know when a home on Hidden Oaks Drive is worth paying attention to, and 53 Hidden Oaks is exactly that kind of property. The combination of a 39,000-square-foot lot, a wine cellar capable of housing over 2,000 bottles, and Venetian plaster walls throughout is genuinely rare at any price point in Lamorinda. When I saw the listing come off the market after 98 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out personally.

A home with these credentials shouldn't sit for three months. The estate has every element that motivates a serious Lafayette buyer - resort-style grounds, a chef's kitchen, a primary suite with a private balcony, and outdoor entertaining infrastructure that most buyers have to imagine. What the listing history suggests is that the marketing never built a complete picture of what this property actually is. At \$810 per square foot, a buyer needed a compelling case for why this home commands that number. That case wasn't made clearly enough, and I think that gap is what kept qualified buyers from moving forward.

I've put together a short analysis of what I believe created friction during the listing period, along with a framework for how a relaunch could be structured differently. The packet walks through the three specific areas where the strategy fell short and what a targeted approach would look like for a home at this level.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside. If you're not, I'd welcome a conversation at whatever pace feels right for you.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Ben Olsen', with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

53 Hidden Oaks Dr

Lafayette, CA 94549

4.0 Beds · 5 Baths · 5,300 Sq Ft · Lafayette

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 53 Hidden Oaks Dr

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Resort-Scale Lafayette Estate - and a Listing That Never Showed It Off

53 Hidden Oaks Drive is a 5,300-square-foot custom estate built in 2006, sitting on nearly nine-tenths of an acre in one of Lafayette's most desirable corridors. The home offers the kind of depth that serious buyers at this price point are actively looking for: Venetian plaster walls and hand-scraped hardwood floors throughout, a wine cellar and tasting room with capacity for over 2,000 bottles, a fully equipped outdoor kitchen with a Lynx pizza oven and DCS rotisserie, a bocce court, pool and spa, and a primary suite with a private balcony and spa-inspired bath. Owned solar and dual generators add a practical layer that resonates with buyers thinking long-term. This is a property with a story.

A 98-day run without a sale doesn't reflect the quality of the home. It reflects a strategy that didn't translate what makes this property exceptional into something buyers could feel before they ever walked through the door. At \$4,295,000 and \$810 per square foot, this listing needed to actively find and persuade a specific buyer who would recognize the value. Instead, it relied on standard distribution and waited. The buyers who would have paid full price likely never saw the home in a way that moved them to act.

\$4,295,000

List Price

\$810/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to do one thing above all else: give the right buyer a complete, immersive experience of this property before they ever schedule a showing. The wine cellar, the outdoor kitchen, the scale of the grounds, the craftsmanship details - these are the reasons someone pays \$4.3 million in Lafayette, and they need to be front and center from the first moment a buyer encounters this home online.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 98 Days Without a Pivot

After 98 days on the market, buyer psychology had long since shifted from curiosity to suspicion. Past the 45-day mark, the typical buyer stops asking what makes a home great and starts asking what everyone else saw that they missed. For a \$4.295 million estate with no HOA and a genuinely rare feature set, that stigma is entirely unearned - but it accumulates quickly without an active change in strategy. The listing didn't run out of time. It ran out of ideas. A home at this level needs a buyer who has been found, not a buyer who happened to scroll past.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses geo-targeted digital campaigns to reach SF and East Bay buyers who are actively researching Lamorinda before they've identified a specific property - putting this home in front of decision-makers rather than waiting for them to find it.

Friction #2: The Visual Story Was Never Told

A temperature-controlled wine cellar with 2,000-bottle capacity, a bocce court lit by string lights, a Lynx pizza oven in an outdoor kitchen, Venetian plaster ceilings - these are features that command a premium because buyers can feel them. But standard MLS photography flattens all of that. Front elevation, wide-angle rooms, flat lighting - none of it conveys the scale of a 39,248-square-foot lot or the texture of a hand-scraped hardwood floor. At \$810 per square foot, buyers comparing this home against alternatives need to experience what they're getting before they drive out for a showing. Without the right visual depth, this home's most compelling features registered as footnotes in the description rather than reasons to act.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

A 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk through every room - including the wine cellar and tasting room - from anywhere, any time, and is especially critical for the out-of-area and busy professional buyers most likely to be shopping at this price point.

Friction #3: A Premium Price That Was Never Defended

At \$810 per square foot, 53 Hidden Oaks sits at the lower end of the premium tier for Lafayette - which means the value case was actually very strong and very makeable. But that case has to be made explicitly. When a listing at this price point doesn't show buyers - in clear, concrete terms - what they're getting that they can't find in a \$720-per-square-foot alternative, price-conscious buyers move on before they ever book a showing. The owned solar, the copper gutters, the custom walnut built-ins, the dual generators, the resort grounds - these are not cosmetic details. They're thousands of dollars of value that the listing treated as supporting copy rather than the headline.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement gives this listing a structured, narrative-forward presence on the platform where most buyers start their search - routing all inquiries directly back to the listing team rather than to third-party agents who don't know the home.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	53 Hidden Oaks Dr	Lafayette Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$810/sqft	Premium tier: \$850–\$920/sqft Updated: \$780–\$840/sqft
Lot / Setting	39,248 sq ft, resort grounds, pool and spa, bocce court, fire pit	Typical Lafayette lot: 7,500–15,000 sq ft
Architectural Character	Custom 2006 estate, Venetian plaster walls and ceilings, hand-scraped hardwood throughout	Standard updated finishes, builder-grade millwork
Premium Features	2,000-bottle wine cellar, outdoor kitchen with pizza oven, owned solar, dual generators, copper gutters	Standard floor plan, single system, no specialty rooms
HOA	None	Varies - \$0 to \$300+/mo depending on community

The verdict: At \$810/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$850-\$920/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$810 per square foot, 53 Hidden Oaks is priced in the lower range of the updated tier and just below the entry point of the formal premium tier - a position that is entirely justified by the lot size, custom construction quality, and specialty features, but one that requires a deliberate marketing strategy to defend. The data supports the number. The prior listing didn't tell buyers why.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Rebuild the Visual Case from the Ground Up

The single most important thing a relaunch can do for this home is give buyers a complete, immersive visual experience before they ever set foot inside. Cinematic photography, a Sky Tour to convey the scale and setting of the nearly one-acre lot, and a full 3D Matterport walkthrough - including the wine cellar and outdoor entertaining spaces - transform casual online browsers into motivated showing requests. Buyers at \$4.3 million are comparing carefully and shopping hard online first. The home that shows the best digitally gets the showing.

Pillar II - Take the Home to the Right Buyers, Not Just the MLS

The buyer for 53 Hidden Oaks is likely a high-earning professional from San Francisco or the inner East Bay who is researching Lamorinda before they know exactly what they want. They are not waiting on Zillow - they need to be found where they are already spending time. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns reach this audience specifically, putting the home in front of decision-makers who are actively in-market but haven't yet locked onto a property. That proactive distribution is what a passive MLS strategy skips.

Pillar III - Tell the Story That Justifies the Number

Owned solar, copper gutters, dual generators, a 2,000-bottle wine cellar, custom walnut closet built-ins, a Lynx outdoor kitchen - this home has thousands of dollars in infrastructure that the prior listing buried in the remarks. A relaunch needs to lead with these details, frame them as computable value, and give buyers the rationale to feel confident at \$4.295 million before the first offer is written. The price is fair. The marketing just never made the case for it.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Ben Olsen | (925) 255-9727 | ben@brightworkrealty.com | brightworkrealty.com

Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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